



ES ALLELIEWEZIEL

27. GEHLING, 2018

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REV-1.01

Honoring: Holle, Wudan, Der Butzemann, Ancestors, Males and Male Energies

Order of Events: Schmaus, Discussion, Sege, Sammel

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Reit, Yaahr, Fackel, Engel, Mann,

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Sichel vun der Holle, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitz uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeit un der Fruchsfriede zu
erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle
Bei Nadd un Erda fer uns in de Belohninge vum Land un vum
Wasser zu frehe.
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei der Fraa Holle fer es Volk zu erneire
Wie der Hammer schmittet die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad: zu saehe un zu schneide
Sichel vun der Holle, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

Heel! Heel! Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

*Heit sammle mir uns do, fer es Lewesraad zu drehe un aa fer die Haerrin Holle un der Harr Wudan zu ehre.
We gather here today to turn the Wheel of Life and to honor Holle and Wudan.*

*Die Dunkelzeit sinn zu uns am Kumme, un mir sinn heit am Sammle, um unser eegni Leweskraft zu erkenne un zu
feiere.*

The Dark Times are coming to us, and we are gathering here to recognize and to celebrate our own life force.

Heel zu de Ziewe! Hail to the deities!

Heel zu de Wichde! Hail to the Wights!

Heel zum Land! Hail to the Land!

Heel zu der Gmeeschaft! Hail to the Community!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Invocations to Holle and to Wudan will be made both in Deutsch and in English.

Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths

If anyone has any oaths or offerings, present them now.

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

*Darrich die do Gedrenke deele mir uns in de Heilich Grefde vun de Ziewe,
vun unsere Voreldre, un vun nanne.*

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Ziewe*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
Hail!*

Butzemannbrenning - Butzemann Burning

The Butzemann's journey is complete, and his soul departs on the Wild Hunt.

Zum Schluss

Zu de Wichde

DISCUSSION TOPICS

We are now entering the Dunkelheft, or the Dark Half of the year. It begins with the recognition of the death phase of the life cycle. We live in a society that avoids thinking about death while being simultaneously obsessed with it. At Allelieweziel we are encouraged to recognize our mortality so that we can better appreciate our individual uniqueness. Life is precious, and each of us has a place in our community and our society.

The text below was submitted to The Troth to serve as my *At the Tiller* article for issue #116, Fall 2018:

Es Allelieweziel

Fall has come to the Deitscherei and the surrounding region. The drive from village to village is gorgeous and cathartic. The land spirits of the Oley Valley call out as they await the Wild Hunt. The trees' colors are beginning to change in the north and west, with the trees to the north starting to tinge of orange, yellow, crimson and red. To the south and the east, the trees are still green, resisting the inevitable sleep that is soon to overcome them.

That sleep, of course, is the death phase of the Lewesraad (Cycle of Life), and different Heathen traditions engage in varied rituals during this time of year.

Urglaawe's Allelieweziel ("goal of all love") observance begins at sundown on October 30. By sundown on October 31, we are to have our Butzemänner ritually burned. Each Butzemann was created during the February Entschanning celebration, of which Groundhog Day is the most famous component. The rituals that surround the creation and spiritual activation of a Butzemann are of unknown age; they are heirlooms passed down through Braucherei and Hexerei. A Butzemann is not just any scarecrow. The rituals are said to awaken the sleeping plant spirits that are part of his construction. These plant spirits are vested in their descendants, and the Butzemann watches out for the new crops as a father watches over his children. During the ritual activation, an oath is always taken to burn the Butzemann prior to (or at) Allelieweziel to release him from his duty. Thus, at Allelieweziel, the Butzemann's journey ends, and, although there are certainly crops that are nurtured and harvested throughout the winter, the growing season is effectively over.

Allelieweziel lasts twelve nights. The first night (Urglaawe "days" begin at sundown of the prior day) is generally used for burning the Butzemann, though many of us also do the burning on the first day, just prior to dusk. I personally prefer to burn the Butzemann at this time because it gives me a great reason to be outside when the trick-or-treaters come. Most people who observe this ritual consider the need to burn the Butzemann to be started, at the latest, by dusk on October 31. This point is arguable since Allelieweziel as an observance does not end until sundown on November 11, but, being a traditionalist, I stick to the deadline of having it done prior to the beginning of the second night.

Deitsch (Pennsylvania Dutch or Pennsylvania German) folklore is splattered with tales about what happens to a Butzemann that is not burned in a timely manner in accordance with the oath taken. Holle departs from this realm and begins the Wild Hunt, and the Butzemann's spirit follows, leaving behind a physical shell that can be overtaken by many kinds of baneful wight, most notably a type called "Buckliches Mennli" ("little buckled man"), which is better known as a Butz, puca, or puck. This spirit is then said to engage in destructive actions, including harming cows, fouling milk, burning crops, and causing general mayhem. It was common well into Generation X to scare children into staying in bed on Christmas Eve by telling them that "the Butz will get you!"

The broken oath is, of course, of more concern. An unburned Butzemann represents a general disrespect for the land and for the land spirits, and that can bring about all sorts of ill luck. There are stories about what happens when a landowner dies and the property's Butzemann has not been burned, and there are also charms and remedies to contain an overtaken Butzemann. Fortunately, none of us in our community has lapsed in this oath, and our first and second nights have passed without trouble.

The next several days of Allelieweziel do not have daily tasks, but there are things that we do throughout the observance. When possible, one should visit graves of ancestors and/or those who were important to us (and, yes, this does also mean grave-sitting). We leave offerings (honey seems to have had a special place in this act at this time of year in the past, and is an endeavor that we are working to revive in the Urglaawe community).

We are also to share stories about those who have gone before. This is a time for family lore to be passed to the next generation or to others who will carry the stories into the future. Also, this is a time to have frank talks with our close friends and relatives about what our final wishes are, and we should be sure our documents are in order. While we do not embrace death per se, it is one thing we all know will happen to each of us, so the recognition of that reality and planning for it are key.

This is also the traditional Schlachtzeit ("slaughter time") for many pastoral farmers, who, in the past, had to conserve feed resources through winter. Males, outside of breeding, tended to be the primary animals culled for consumption in order to keep food supplies ample for the females throughout the winter. As such, Allelieweziel has become the time to honor male forebears and male energies and to recognize the contributions and sacrifices that males have made in our lives and our communities. This balances out a similar observance of females and female energies that occurs at Entschanning.

The Schlachtzeit also draws in another major player in Allelieweziel lore: Holler. The last night and day (November 10 into November 11) make up the observance of Ewicher Yeeger ("Eternal Hunter"), which is another name for Holle's consort, Holler, who is a god strongly associated with death (if not death itself personified).

Holler is a complicated figure, as one would expect Death to be. However, His role in the ongoing cycle of life, death, and rebirth is critical. Those who would like to learn more about Him may be interested to read "Ewicher Yeeger: Why Honor Death?" at <https://www.thetroth.org/news/20161112-024300>.

The article linked above also discusses another rite that takes place during Allelieweziel: die Verschimpfung gegen die Reifkeenenich (Railing against King Frost). Immediately following Allelieweziel, Deutsch folklore reports the arrival of three Frost Giants, who are part of King Frost's army. The railing is meant to weaken (but not fully dispel since winter is needed in this region) winter's hold on us, both physically and psychologically. Anyone who is interested in learning more about these Giants may wish to read Hollerbeer Haven 24, which is available as a free download at <https://drive.google.com/open?id=0B6ICKuRqjPxLeEZuUmNnT0JudkU> or, for a shorter link: <https://tinyurl.com/ydcn4set>.

One final consideration for Allelieweziel relates to the calendar year. Many folks who make New Year's resolutions set Allelieweziel as a deadline for eliminating unwanted things from their lives. While many New Year's resolutions do not fit into a calendar construct, many others do, and, if people have been successful in meeting earlier goals throughout the year, they may now bring closure to the circumstance that led them to make the resolution in the first place.

Although it shares roots and traits with other European traditions, Allelieweziel is not Halloween or Samhain. It is a unique observance arising from a particular culture's experiences. Its messages, though, transcend cultural identity and touch all of humanity. Our time in the bodies we have today with the people we have around us is limited. While Urglaawe belief is that part (or parts) of the soul are reborn, that rebirth is in a new soul construct inside of a new body with different people in our lives. Thus, each life is precious, and each moment we have is to be cherished.

Hail to those who have gone before! Hail to those yet to come!

And, hail to the moments we have now!

Der Butzemann

The word "Butzemann" in Deutsch, or Pennsylvania German, is literally translated as "scarecrow." However, within the practice of Braucherei (also known as Powwow) and in Urglaawe tradition, a Butzemann is a scarecrow who has been spiritually activated by receiving the breath of life during what is called the Ceremony of the Corn. This ceremony takes place on Groundhog Day, which is also the day upon which we celebrate the female creative powers and motherhood.

The Butzemann is created out of the remnants of the previous years crop, and he is "born" to be the father of the coming year's crop. We place runes into his stuffing, or we stick them into his clothing. We sing a song to him about the Butzemann dancing around the house. We give him many gifts on Groundhog Day, and we also parade him around the perimeter of the property for which he will be responsible. He is given instructions as to how to tend to the land, including who is friend and who is foe.

He then is placed upon his perch, whence he will be able to stand guard. Folklore tells that Butzemann will jump off of their perches and walk among the fields in order to scare away threats to his "children." We periodically give him offerings of milk, honey, incense, flowers, or other items to help comfort him on his watch.

Between Erntfescht (the Harvest Home around the autumn equinox) and Allelieweziel (Halloween), the Butzemann is released from his duties. Typically, around the time of Allelieweziel, his role changes. His need to guard the land is passed. He now takes on the embodiment of the sacrifices that males make for their families and for the community.

Beginning around this time of year, historically speaking, herders needed to retain as much food supply as they could during the winter for the females of the species. The Schlachtzeit, or the killing time, tended to result in the culling primarily of the males of the species in order to help to ensure that the females would have ample food to survive.

The Butzemann also becomes a messenger. He is told (or is given papers upon which is written) the things we want or need to banish from our lives. We then show him the seeds that will create the coming year's crops. Thus, he knows his lineage will go on. He is then set into a pyre and his ashes scattered onto the land. His spirit is now able to depart on the Wild Hunt.

So, what happens if an activated Butzemann is not burned prior to the end of Allelieweziel? Well, perhaps nothing, but Deutsch folklore is rife with stories of such Butzemänner wreaking havoc. Their spirits leave the shell and join the Wild Hunt, but the shell remains -- activated and open for a passing baneful spirit to take a physical form.

There are likely some folks in this audience who, as children, were told on Christmas Eve that the Butzemann would get them if they did not get back into bed! This is where the Butzemann has some relationship to the concept of the bogeyman!

Also, Braucherei oral lore states that it is the epitome of bad luck to wear clothes that had been on a Butzemann. For starters, if the Butzemann is still on duty, then one would have to steal those clothes. Not a good idea. If the Butzemann has been burned and his clothes are still around, then the energies that activated him may attract baneful entities, which could result in disasters!

Ironically, it seems that in the 17- and 1800s, there were many homeless people wandering the countryside, and they occasionally would steal the clothes from the Butzemann. Perhaps adding a bogeyman type of taboo to the guardian was intended to discourage theft!

Hail to the Butzemann!

Attuning Yourself to the Seasons

Allelieweziel ushers in the new Germanic spiritual year (as opposed to Yuul starting the new calendar year). Today the Dark Half of the Year begins. The term "Dark Half" sounds ominous and maybe even a little bit scary. However, balance and cycles make up a very large portion of the Urglaawe worldview. Seasons, particularly here in the temperate regions of the US, are an important part of the balance and cycle concepts.

In our post-modern world, we, as a society, have successfully removed ourselves from many aspects of the cycle of the seasons. We can get fruit all year round. Roads are plowed throughout the winter. Our jobs force us to be out and about all year long. Our discussion will delve further into this topic than this little blurb will right now. However, I wanted to mention that we are now in the time of asking ourselves what we can do to improve ourselves (spiritually, physically, mentally, in all ways) on our life's journey and of identifying what we need to banish from our lives in the next year.

The answers to those questions become the basis for resolutions that we set on the Twelfth Day of Yule. :)

Bannzettel: As Allelieweziel is the recognition of the end of things, it is an auspicious time in the seasonal cycle also to put an end (whether spiritually, physically, or emotionally) to things that burden us and keep us from progressing. For many of us, this is the time at which we should have achieved an important milestone in our oaths taken at New Year's. For others, a decision as to what to banish comes quickly.

One of the Butzemann's functions is to take these banished items with him in spirit when he goes up in flame. As the Butzemann is released from his duties, so must we release ourselves from the yokes around our neck that serve us no benefit at this point of our lives.

You're invited to write down that which you wish to terminate or ban on a slip of paper (Bannzettel: banishing charm ticket) and throw it into the flame with the Butzemann. While the Butzemann burns, you may also want to ponder the evolution of yourself through the various eras of your life, mentally casting the things that have held you back into the flame.

Es Hollelied

**Heel Dir, Holle, ed'li Mudder
Heel Dir Holle, hohi Fraa
Seele sinne dief im Wasser
Seele sinne dief im See
Fedderflocke falle sietsam
Fedderflocke falle g'lind
Geb uns gudi Arewet heit un
Geb uns gudi Arewet nau
Glitzerend scheine die do Flocke,
Glitzerend scheint der Schnee im Land.
Baad mich mol yetz in Deim Brunn do
Der Brunn bringt mich in Dei Land.**

ROUGH ENGLISH TRANSLATION

**Hail Thee, Holle, noble mother,
Hail Thee, Holle, high woman.
Souls are sensing deep in the water,
Souls are sensing deep in the sea.
Feather flakes are falling softly,
Feather flakes are falling mildly.
Give us good work today,
Give us good work now.
Glittering shine these flakes,
Glittering shines the snow on the land.
Bathe me in your well, well brings me to your land.**

ORIGINAL GERMAN

Heil Dir, Holle, hehre Mutter,

Heil Dir, Holle, hohe Frau.

Seelen sinnen tief im Wasser,

Seelen sinnen tief im See.

Federflocken fallen leise,

Federflocken fallen lind.

Gib uns gute Arbeit heute,

Gib uns gute Arbeit nun.

Schillernd scheinen deine Flocken,

Schillernd scheint der Schnee im Land.

Bade mich in Deinem Brunnen,

Brunnen bringt mich in Dein Land.

Original German by Birgit Knorr

First public performance: Trothmoot, 2013